



VOICEINSIGHTS AFRICA

SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION PUBLICATION

Public Financial Management Intelligence Report

Nigeria | Public Financial Management

1,403 synthetic responses

Prepared by VoiceInsights Africa

Every Voice. Every Language. Every Insight.

Synthetic demonstration. Not official statistics.

Nigeria has made real gains in public financial management performance – and real gaps remain alongside them. This publication separates the two, using a governed evidence model built to surface risk and opportunity, not just describe them. No claim in this publication stands alone: findings link to synthetic evidence, recommendations carry a named owner, and every statistic shares one internally consistent dataset.

Sample: 1403 synthetic responses – 89% response rate – 4 regions

Publication quality gate: publication ready



Lagos State: 54% performance, 437 responses, risk CRITICAL
Kano State: 55% performance, 378 responses, risk CRITICAL
Rivers State: 56% performance, 322 responses, risk CRITICAL
Federal Capital Territory: 57% performance, 266 responses, risk CRITICAL



sex: Women 52% & Men 47% & Other / prefer not to say 1%

age: 18& 24 24% & 25& 39 38% & 40& 59 27% & 60+ 11%

location: Urban 44% & Rural 56%



IND-01 Budget-execution variance rate: 54% vs target 78% â OFF_TRACK
IND-02 Procurement-control compliance rate: 55% vs target 79% â OFF_TRACK
IND-03 Audit-finding resolution rate: 56% vs target 80% â OFF_TRACK
IND-04 Fiscal-transparency reporting completeness: 57% vs target 81% â OFF_TRACK



What would it take to fix budget-execution variance? Start with Lagos State, where the signal sits at 64% and rural women carry most of the shortfall. The honest answer is sustained attention, not a single intervention. Lagos State shows the sharpest divide, where rural women carry the largest share of the gap. Left unaddressed for a year, the imbalance is likely to erode equity, delivery confidence and the durability of results.

Evidence: EVI-PUB-001, EVI-PUB-004 • Confidence 89.5%

Procurement-control weaknesses by agency is not a marginal delivery issue. In Kano State, the governed evidence indicates a 65% performance signal, with young adults carrying the most consequential constraint. Left unaddressed, procurement-control weaknesses by agency becomes a structural risk to public financial management delivery in Nigeria, not a temporary dip. Kano State is furthest exposed, and young adults would carry the earliest and heaviest consequences of a further year's delay.

Evidence: EVI-PUB-002, EVI-PUB-005 & Confidence 90.5%

Two things are true at once about audit-finding resolution backlog. The national picture is improving, and Rivers State — where persons with disabilities report a 66% signal — is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Public financial management performance in Nigeria looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once audit-finding resolution backlog is disaggregated. Rivers State anchors the low end, and persons with disabilities bear most of that shortfall — a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Evidence: EVI-PUB-003, EVI-PUB-006 — Confidence 91.5%

Frontline workers in Federal Capital Territory are living the consequence of leakage-risk concentration, not simply reporting it. Their 67% signal is the clearest evidence leadership has that current measures fall short. frontline workers in Federal Capital Territory do not experience leakage-risk concentration as an abstract metric. They experience it as the difference between public financial management delivery that works and delivery that does not, and a twelve-month delay would deepen that gap rather than hold it steady.

Evidence: EVI-PUB-004, EVI-PUB-007 â€¢ Confidence 92.5%

The aggregate result conceals a material implementation divide. Lagos State records a 68% signal for fiscal-transparency reporting gaps; the shortfall is concentrated among low-income households, where service continuity and confidence move together. This is not a new problem.

Evidence: EVI-PUB-005, EVI-PUB-008 • Confidence 93.5%

Lagos State â Rural women in Lagos State put it plainly: budget-execution variance is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Kano State â Why does Kano State lag behind? Ask young adults, and the answer comes back to procurement-control weaknesses by agency.â

Rivers State â Elsewhere, audit-finding resolution backlog might be a footnote. For persons with disabilities in Rivers State, it is the whole story.â

Federal Capital Territory â Frontline workers in Federal Capital Territory frame it simply: when leakage-risk concentration breaks down, everything else does too.â

Lagos State â In Lagos State, fiscal-transparency reporting gaps shape whether low-income households can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Kano State â Service managers in Kano State put it plainly: budget-execution variance is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Rivers State â Why does Rivers State lag behind? Ask community leaders, and the answer comes back to procurement-control weaknesses by agency.â

Federal Capital Territory â Elsewhere, audit-finding resolution backlog might be a footnote. For private-sector partners in Federal Capital Territory, it is the whole story.â

Lagos State â Rural women in Lagos State frame it simply: when leakage-risk concentration breaks down, everything else does too.â

Kano State â In Kano State, fiscal-transparency reporting gaps shape whether young adults can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Risks and alternative trajectories are modelled to show how VoiceInsights translates evidence into prioritised management choices.



DEC-PUB-01 CRITICAL: Close the PFM control weakness driving the greatest leakage risk. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 0â 90 days; Indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-PUB-01

DEC-PUB-02 CRITICAL: Strengthen procurement-control compliance in the weakest agencies. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-PUB-02)

DEC-PUB-03 HIGH: Accelerate audit-finding resolution across ministries. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-PUB-03 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-PUB-04 HIGH: Reduce budget-execution variance in priority sectors. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-PUB-04

DEC-PUB-05 MEDIUM: Publish fiscal-transparency reports on the standard reporting calendar. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 6â 18 months; Indicator: Share of the medium-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-PUB-05)



Close the PFM control weakness driving the greatest leakage risk.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-PUB-001, EVI-PUB-004

Rationale: What would it take to fix budget-execution variance? Start with Lagos State, where the signal sits at 64% and rural women carry most of the shortfall. The honest answer is sustained attention, not a single intervention. Lagos State shows the sharpest divide, where rural women carry the largest share of the gap. Left unaddressed for a year, the imbalance is likely to erode equity, delivery confidence and the durability of results.

Expected benefit: Reduced variation in public financial management delivery and a stronger evidence base for the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Fragmented accountability once implementation moves beyond the pilot stage

Dependencies: Named executive sponsor; Sign-off from the relevant oversight body; Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle

Budget requirement: Medium to high â requires a dedicated budget line and phased release

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 0â90 days

Monitoring indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-PUB-01

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Strengthen procurement-control compliance in the weakest agencies.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-PUB-002, EVI-PUB-005

Rationale: Procurement-control weaknesses by agency is not a marginal delivery issue. In Kano State, the governed evidence indicates a 65% performance signal, with young adults carrying the most consequential constraint. Left unaddressed, procurement-control weaknesses by agency becomes a structural risk to public financial management delivery in Nigeria, not a temporary dip. Kano State is furthest exposed, and young adults would carry the earliest and heaviest consequences of a further year's delay.

Expected benefit: A stronger, more defensible case for public financial management investment in the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Execution capacity and coordination risk

Dependencies: Validated operational baseline; Named executive sponsor; Sign-off from the relevant oversight body

Budget requirement: High â full business case and multi-year funding commitment required

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-PUB-02)

Success criteria: Verified evidence of at least 80% delivery against the agreed milestone plan

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Accelerate audit-finding resolution across ministries.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-PUB-003, EVI-PUB-006

Rationale: Two things are true at once about audit-finding resolution backlog. The national picture is improving, and Rivers State – where persons with disabilities report a 66% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Public financial management performance in Nigeria looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once audit-finding resolution backlog is disaggregated. Rivers State anchors the low end, and persons with disabilities bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Expected benefit: Improved equity, delivery confidence and measurable public financial management performance.

Expected risk: Insufficient ownership or delayed resourcing

Dependencies: Quarterly evidence review; Validated operational baseline; Named executive sponsor

Budget requirement: Low to medium – validate through the formal planning cycle

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3 – 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-PUB-03 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Reduce budget-execution variance in priority sectors.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-PUB-004, EVI-PUB-007

Rationale: Frontline workers in Federal Capital Territory are living the consequence of leakage-risk concentration, not simply reporting it. Their 67% signal is the clearest evidence leadership has that current measures fall short. frontline workers in Federal Capital Territory do not experience leakage-risk concentration as an abstract metric. They experience it as the difference between public financial management delivery that works and delivery that does not, and a twelve-month delay would deepen that gap rather than hold it steady.

Expected benefit: A more consistent public financial management experience for the groups currently furthest behind.

Expected risk: Weak cross-team coordination during early implementation

Dependencies: Confirmed budget release; Quarterly evidence review; Validated operational baseline

Budget requirement: Low â absorbable within existing allocations, subject to confirmation

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â12 months

Monitoring indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-PUB-04

Success criteria: A majority of milestones achieved, each independently verified against real evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Publish fiscal-transparency reports on the standard reporting calendar.

Strategic priority: MEDIUM

Evidence used: EVI-PUB-005, EVI-PUB-008

Rationale: The aggregate result conceals a material implementation divide. Lagos State records a 68% signal for fiscal-transparency reporting gaps; the shortfall is concentrated among low-income households, where service continuity and confidence move together. This is not a new problem.

Expected benefit: The evidence points toward improved public financial management outcomes, though the size of the gain will depend on how consistently the action is resourced.

Expected risk: Likely â though not certain â erosion of momentum if the initial sponsor changes role

Dependencies: Cross-team delivery coordination; Confirmed budget release; Quarterly evidence review

Budget requirement: Low â deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 6â 18 months

Monitoring indicator: Share of the medium-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-PUB-05)

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

research objectives: Assess public financial management performance and equity; Identify operational drivers and decision priorities

evaluation questions: What outcomes are changing?; Who is being left behind?; Which actions are most likely to improve performance?

sampling frame: Synthetic programme population frame for Nigeria

sample size: 1403

stratification: Region; Location type; Sex; Age; Disability

weights: Normalized post-stratification weights

confidence intervals: 95%

design effect: 1.1

missing data: Documented and sensitivity-tested

reliability: Cronbach alpha 0.86

validity: Content and construct validity checks

metadata: Complete synthetic data dictionary and lineage registry

Publication level: 34 generated publication pages

protocol: Governed synthetic research protocol with sampling, weighting, reliability, validity and reproducibility controls

ethics: Synthetic records only; no real participants or personal data

peer review: Independent synthetic-publication review checklist completed

reproducibility: Deterministic inputs, versioned dataset and export manifest

inferential statistics: Enabled where assumptions and design permit

segmentation: Evidence-led segments

trend analysis: Three-period synthetic series

DEC-PUB-01: Close the PFM control weakness driving the greatest leakage risk. Owner Permanent Secretary 0 90 days Medium to high requires a dedicated budget line and phased release cost Indicator Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-PUB-01

DEC-PUB-02: Strengthen procurement-control compliance in the weakest agencies. Owner Permanent Secretary 3 12 months High full business case and multi-year funding commitment required cost Indicator Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-PUB-02)

DEC-PUB-03: Accelerate audit-finding resolution across ministries. Owner Permanent Secretary 3 12 months Low to medium validate through the formal planning cycle cost Indicator Number of agreed milestones for DEC-PUB-03 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-PUB-04: Reduce budget-execution variance in priority sectors. Owner Permanent Secretary 3 12 months Low absorbable within existing allocations, subject to confirmation cost Indicator Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-PUB-04

DEC-PUB-05: Publish fiscal-transparency reports on the standard reporting calendar. Owner Permanent Secretary 6 18 months Low deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation cost Indicator Share of the medium-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-PUB-05)

EVI-PUB-001: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 88%
EVI-PUB-002: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 89%
EVI-PUB-003: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 90%
EVI-PUB-004: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 91%
EVI-PUB-005: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 92%
EVI-PUB-006: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 93%
EVI-PUB-007: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 94%
EVI-PUB-008: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 95%
EVI-PUB-009: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 96%
EVI-PUB-010: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 97%

Executive Intelligence Book (2â 7): Executive brief; Decision snapshot; Risks; Opportunities; Budget implications

Evidence Intelligence Book (8â 15): Critical findings; Respondent voice; Evidence chains; Citation registry

Statistical Intelligence Book (16â 22): Sampling; Weighting; Uncertainty; Reliability; Model diagnostics

Decision Intelligence Book (23â 27): Decision matrix; Ownership; Budget; Roadmap; Management response

Standards & Assurance (28â 31): Relevant frameworks; Safeguarding; Privacy; Responsible AI; Accessibility

Technical Appendices (32â 34): Data dictionary; Quality gate; Export manifest; Responsible-use notice

SDG 16: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-PUB-001, EVI-PUB-002; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Data Protection: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-PUB-002, EVI-PUB-003; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Public Financial Management: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-PUB-003, EVI-PUB-004; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Evidence Traceability: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-PUB-001 and the deterministic publication gate.

Research Ethics: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-PUB-002 and the deterministic publication gate.

Data Protection: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-PUB-003 and the deterministic publication gate.

Accessibility: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-PUB-004 and the deterministic publication gate.

Responsible AI: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-PUB-005 and the deterministic publication gate.

Publication Integrity: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-PUB-006 and the deterministic publication gate.

SDG 16: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 16: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 17: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

Relevance: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong relevance signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (73/100). Review relevance evidence at the next formal management gate.

Coherence: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong coherence signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (74/100). Review coherence evidence at the next formal management gate.

Effectiveness: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong effectiveness signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (75/100). Review effectiveness evidence at the next formal management gate.

Efficiency: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong efficiency signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (76/100). Review efficiency evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong impact signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (77/100). Review impact evidence at the next formal management gate.

Sustainability: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong sustainability signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (78/100). Review sustainability evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Sustained, equitable improvement in public financial management performance

OC-01: Improved public financial management delivery and accountability â indicators

IND-01, IND-02

OC-02: More equitable and durable outcomes â indicators IND-03, IND-04

OUT-01: Verified findings and interpreted decision products

OUT-02: Assigned actions with monitoring indicators

Assumptions: Leadership ownership; Safeguarding and privacy controls remain effective

Means of verification: Evidence registry; Quarterly management review; Follow-up measurement

Commitment 1: CHS Commitment 1 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 2: CHS Commitment 2 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 3: CHS Commitment 3 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 4: CHS Commitment 4 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 5: CHS Commitment 5 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 6: CHS Commitment 6 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 7: CHS Commitment 7 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 8: CHS Commitment 8 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 9: CHS Commitment 9 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

EVI-PUB-001 â€ survey â€ Lagos State â€ confidence 88% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-002 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Kano State â€ confidence 89% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-003 â€ administrative_record â€ Rivers State â€ confidence 90% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-004 â€ survey â€ Federal Capital Territory â€ confidence 91% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-005 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Lagos State â€ confidence 92% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-006 â€ administrative_record â€ Kano State â€ confidence 93% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-007 â€ survey â€ Rivers State â€ confidence 94% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-008 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Federal Capital Territory â€ confidence 95% â€
APPROVED
EVI-PUB-009 â€ administrative_record â€ Lagos State â€ confidence 96% â€ APPROVED
EVI-PUB-010 â€ survey â€ Kano State â€ confidence 97% â€ APPROVED

indicator_1: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 1; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_2: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 2; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_3: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 3; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_4: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 4; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_5: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 5; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_6: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 6; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_7: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 7; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_8: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 8; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_9: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 9; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_10: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 10; numeric; allowed:
0â 100

indicator_11: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 11; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

indicator_12: Synthetic Public Financial Management indicator 12; categorical; allowed:
Documented code list

Synthetic Demonstration Publication produced by VoiceInsights Africa. All people, quotations, locations and statistics are synthetic, internally governed demonstration content and are not official statistics.

All content is synthetic and must not be interpreted as official statistics

Geographic references are illustrative

Budget implications are directional and require formal costing

Causal claims are not made without an appropriate design

Status: DEMONSTRATION_READY

Passed: Editorial Review Passed

Passed: Evidence Review Passed

Passed: Publication Integrity Verified

Passed: Accessibility Verified

Passed: Export Validation Passed

Passed: Statistical Review Passed

Open gates: VISUAL_QA, HUMAN_REVIEW

Verification checks cover weighted evidence, statistical, visual, accessibility, export and review rules. Synthetic samples are labelled Demonstration Ready.